Yenny Otero

Group Design Lead | Design systems and regulated financial journeys, hands-on in code

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PROFILE

Design leader for regulated, multi-stakeholder financial products. At TSB I built the design function and design system from zero, with a team of up to 17 working alongside IBM engineers, and took the mobile app from 1.8 to 4.6 App Store stars. At Vanquis I led customer experience for 1.7M+ customers, with a team of 15, and built an inclusive-design framework for vulnerable customers under FCA rules. I stay hands-on: I build in React and TypeScript, and publish a design system with accessibility checks in CI (ds.yennyotero.com). Executive MBA, Warwick Business School.

SKILLS AND TOOLS

Design Leadership · Design Systems and Platform Components · Regulated Financial Services · Onboarding Journeys · Accessibility and Inclusive Design · Cross-functional Leadership · Complex Enterprise UX · Prototyping in Code · Behavioural Design

AI	Claude · Claude Code · Claude API
Build	TypeScript · React · Next.js · Supabase · Postgres · Vercel · Playwright · Python · GitHub
Design	Figma · Miro · Jira
Languages	Spanish (native) · English, Italian and Norwegian (fluent)

EXPERIENCE

Co-founder and Director, Neon Lighthouse — 2023 – Present

AI product studio: designing, validating and building AI-native products.

- Building Breathing Room, an AI financial-wellbeing coach based on my MBA research on financial avoidance.

Founder and Product Lead, Bachata Connect — 2014 – Present

Dance training platform for dancers and teaching artists, grown from Bachata Week Cádiz, the international training week I founded in 2014: about 1,500 applications a year for about 300 places, and 349 participants from 45 countries in 2026.

- Ship to engineering standards: strict TypeScript, Playwright end-to-end tests, WCAG AA contrast checks in CI, small PRs behind feature flags.
- Designed and evaluated an AI assistant for participants: grounded answers with server-verified sources, hand-off to the team, and an eval bench scoring correctness, grounding, hand-off and tone across prompt versions.
- Designed and built it solo: about 1,580 commits and 443 merged pull requests in five months.
- Replaced 20-minute manual registration with NFC check-in: 344 arrivals in two afternoons, 340 linking a band.

Head of Customer Experience, Vanquis Bank — Apr 2023 – Apr 2026

Owned customer-experience strategy across consumer-finance products serving 1.7M+ customers; led a team of 15.

- Led early-intervention strategy for credit cards and vehicle finance, helping customers see debt building before arrears.
- Led journey and experience design for Moneybarn's new platform for two years, then managed the product.
- Built an inclusive-design framework that put accessibility and vulnerability awareness into delivery; co-authored the Vulnerable Customer Policy.

Head of Design, Customer Experience and Innovation, TSB Bank — 2018 – 2023

Owned product design and customer experience through TSB's digital transformation.

- Led the mobile app from 1.8 to 4.6 App Store stars.
- Led the customer response to the 2018 platform migration.
- Built the in-house design function and design system from zero, a team of up to 17. With no product managers, my team led the product roadmap.

Lead Product Designer, SapientRazorfish — 2017 – 2018

Led product strategy and experience design for Amplifon's hearing-aid app: six international awards including The Drum DADI and EPICA, and 6,500+ downloads in its first four months.

- Designed the app as a companion for the first weeks of wearing a hearing aid, helping people adapt and reducing stigma.

Lead Product and Service Designer, Designit — 2013 – 2017

Owned projects end to end, from discovery and strategy to delivery; four direct reports.

- Redesigned breast cancer diagnosis at Oslo University Hospital, from 12 weeks to 6 days; adopted as Norway's national standard.
- Led experience design for Pepper, Bank Leumi's mobile-only bank in Israel, a zero-to-one product, including its onboarding.
- Redesigned Scandinavian Airlines' EuroBonus loyalty proposition and its new app and web interfaces.

Developer, then Interaction Designer, Opera Software — 2002 – 2013 · Oslo, Tokyo, Beijing

Employee 69. Built and designed browsers for the Nintendo DSi and Wii and for Motorola phones.

EDUCATION

Executive MBA, Warwick Business School — 2023 – 2026

Dissertation: From Avoidance to Agency, on why people avoid dealing with their money

Certificate of Specialisation in Strategy, Harvard Business School — 2023

BSc Informatics (computer engineering), University of Oslo — 1999 – 2004